

**POR 316 Androidview**

Portronics launched its POR 316 Androidview projector with in-built Wi-Fi and Android operating system. It is available for ₹28,999

**Sony Xperia Tablet Z**

Sony announced the worldwide availability of its ultra-thin Xperia Tablet Z, with a price tag of \$499.99

Imagining Tomorrow's Imaging Tech, Today

A peek into the future of cellphone cameras which is spelling doom for basic point and shoots

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The idea of being able to capture real life onto a still frame was something that spurred thoughts of witchcraft. At least that's how it was back in the dark ages, until the 1800s when innovators like Louis Daguerre, Joseph Niépce and Thomas Wedgwood shot the first set of photographs using a "camera obscura." Cut to some two hundred and thirteen years later, and here we are again, talking about camera tech that could, once again, only be out of something like science fiction, but that's the beauty of life.

Imagination fuels science fiction, and science fiction fuels the fascination of the select few who would love to see the imaginary get turned into real. That pretty much has become the premise of all inventions, every fascinating gadget we see coming out these days. But let's go back to photography here. We've seen some remarkable improvements in imaging technology in the last 10 years. Going from a digital camera that required a shoulder pack for power and storage to cameras that can fit into our pockets and store thousands of images at a time. We can shoot images of race cars that defy their top speeds, or shoot objects so tiny that even our eyes don't register them, yet, there is room for more. Scientists and engineers are working round the clock to bring to your camera today, some impressive technology of tomorrow and we're going to tell you just what they are.



Lytro Red Hot camera

F**K The Focus

When Lytro was demoed on October 19, 2011, the world held its breath in sheer awe of what they were seeing. The camera created images which could be refocused after being shot, so that you would always have the perfect shot and not worry about missing focus. This camera also had promising implications for journalists, for whom not having to worry about critical focus would have greatly improved their chances of nailing their award winning shot. But Lytro didn't pick up as much as everyone had thought it would simply because the final resolution of the images from the camera was just a little over one megapixel.



Apple iPhone 5 Pro concept featuring a 1.2MP 3D camera and a projector

Cue the future, as it is being envisioned and developed by Pelican Imaging. These guys are essentially developing tech very similar to the Lytro, but unlike Lytro and other array-based or so-called plenoptic cameras, it uses a small array of traditional imaging elements. Each of these elements is sensitive only to a single color. Pelican's unique approach provides it with one huge differentiator — its sensor module is self-contained, with no additional lens required.

What the Pelican developed sensor will be able to do is not just capture light, but also capture the direction of that light. What it also does is divide its entire imaging surface into "mini cameras", each of which capture only one colour. The information from each individual "mini camera" is then compiled together through mathematical wizardry to yield data worth 16.7 megapixels, which finally results in an 8 megapixel image. The best part, everything in the image, from the foreground to the farthest object in the background will be in focus. There really won't be a need to refocus the image after its shot, which is the best part. Now imagine this tech making its way into your camera phone. Rumour has